



AMY RAYGADA

Team Lead, Data & AI Governance

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data and AI governance specialist with 18+ years of experience designing, implementing, and embedding governance frameworks across global enterprise environments. Currently leading the Central Europe Data & AI Service Line at Thoughtworks, responsible for governance architecture, EU AI Act and GDPR compliance, and the operationalisation of responsible AI across enterprise clients. Deep hands-on experience with Microsoft Purview, Collibra, and OpenMetadata, and a track record of translating complex regulatory requirements into practical controls, playbooks, and self-service tooling that engineering and business teams actually adopt. I build governance that enables speed, not just enforces compliance. Co-authored a published book series on Data Products and teach executive cohorts at O'Reilly. German B1, English native.

EXPERIENCE

Thoughtworks · Deputy Director, Data & AI Service Line, Central Europe

April 2026 – Present · Germany

Strategic and operational leadership of the Central Europe Data & AI practice, with governance quality and regulatory alignment as a core accountability across all active engagements.

- Define and enforce governance standards across the regional Data & AI portfolio: data quality, metadata management, model transparency, lineage, and compliance controls
- Lead 54 consultants and technical leads across Romania, Amsterdam, and Germany, including coaching on governance frameworks, delivery standards, and regulatory requirements
- Govern engagement quality across concurrent programmes, identifying misalignments between contracted scope and client expectations before they become delivery failures
- Contribute to internal frameworks, accelerators, and governance methodologies that improve delivery consistency and scalability across the practice
- Represent the organisation externally through conferences, executive forums, and published thought leadership on AI governance and responsible AI

Thoughtworks · Principal Data & AI Strategist, Data Governance Lead

September 2024 – Present · Germany

Hands-on design and implementation of Data and AI governance frameworks for global enterprise clients across financial services, energy, and regulated industries.

- Architected AI governance frameworks for EU AI Act, GDPR, GxP, and HIPAA compliance: defined control mechanisms, embedded explainability, risk scoring, and model traceability directly into ML and GenAI pipelines
- Designed and implemented modern data governance operating models using Microsoft Purview and AWS-native governance services: federated stewardship, ownership workflows, metadata cataloguing, and data lineage
- Integrated governance into analytics and AI delivery processes by design, including CI/CD, DataOps, and MLOps workflows, ensuring compliance does not block delivery velocity

- Defined KPIs, review processes, and control mechanisms for data and AI quality across enterprise client environments
- Built governance playbooks and self-service guidance consumable by both engineering teams and business stakeholders, driving adoption without requiring centralised oversight for every decision
- Translated EU AI Act, GDPR, and Data Act requirements into practical implementation standards and controls for client technical teams
- Delivered governance workshops and advisory sessions for C-suite and senior stakeholders at global enterprise clients
- Stack: Microsoft Purview, Collibra, OpenMetadata, AWS, Azure, GCP, Python, SQL

Cosmodata Strategy & Management · CEO & Founder

March 2024 – Present · Germany

Founded AI advisory practice with data governance as a core offering.

- Designed and delivered governance frameworks, AI operating models, and metadata strategies for enterprise clients across Europe and North America
- Built governance playbooks and self-service tooling guidance for CDOs and data teams entering AI adoption programmes
- Hosted the Cosmo Data Summit and "Data Chronicles" live show, establishing a peer network of CDOs and AI governance leaders

Data Masterclass · Data Management Coach

March 2025 – Present · Remote

- Coach data and AI leaders on governance capability building, operating model design, and translating regulatory requirements into operational practice

BayWa r.e. Global · Senior Data Solutions Program Lead

April 2024 – August 2024 · Munich

- Developed data governance framework and master data domain architecture for a global renewables enterprise operating across regulated energy markets
- Defined data quality controls and integration flows across ERP, CRM, and HR systems; advised on technology partner selection
- Stack: Azure, Snowflake, Informatica, Workday, Salesforce

SMG Swiss Marketplace Group · Head of Data Product

January 2022 – March 2024

- Implemented Data Governance and Data Mesh principles across 4 business units: ownership models, quality standards, stewardship workflows, and KPI frameworks
- Built the Group Data Product Enablement Team from zero: hired and led a cross-functional team; OKRs drove goal completion up 75%
- Drove data infrastructure utilisation and self-serve analytics adoption up 100% through governance tooling, automation, and clear guidance
- Stack: GCP, Looker, BigQuery, Fivetran, dbt

Flightright · Data Engineer / Data Product Owner

July 2021 – January 2022 · Berlin

- Ran POC for ETL automation and data governance tooling; built and maintained production data pipelines
- Stack: Postgres, Python, SQL, Tableau, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS

Joyn GmbH · Data Quality Engineer

August 2020 – July 2021 · Munich

- Built data warehouse testing framework and data governance tooling: data dictionary, glossary, ERD diagrams
- Investigated and resolved data quality issues, improving data quality by 78%
- Stack: SQL, Snowflake, dbt, DataVault 2.0, AWS, Python, Kafka, BigQuery

EARLIER CAREER (CONDENSED)

Intertec International · Testing and Validation Lead (2013-2016): built testing team from 2 to 14 people in 6 months; implemented enterprise data hub across six US states.

Syniverse · Engineering Manager (2016-2017): scaled automated test suite from 100 to 600 tests; saved \$200K/year; improved acceptance rate by 40%.

SKILLS

Governance and Compliance: EU AI Act · GDPR · Data Act · HIPAA · GxP · AI risk management · Model transparency · Data lineage · Metadata management · Data quality · Responsible AI · MLOps governance · DataOps governance

Tooling: Microsoft Purview · Collibra · OpenMetadata · dbt · Databricks · Kafka · Snowflake · BigQuery · AWS · Azure · GCP · Python · SQL

Frameworks and Methods: Federated stewardship · Data Mesh · Data product operating models · CI/CD governance · Playbook and policy authoring · Self-service governance design · KPI and control framework design

Leadership: Team building · Coaching and development · Stakeholder management · CXO advisory · Cross-functional collaboration · Legal, compliance, and data protection partnership

PUBLICATIONS AND COURSES

Book: *Building Data Products* (trilogy, co-authored with Paolo Platter) · Technics Publications, 2025-2026 · amzn.eu/d/9MMVPiX

Live Course: Data Products and AI Strategy · O'Reilly, May-Nov 2025 · Executive cohort for CDOs, Heads of Data and Analytics, Data and AI Strategists

EDUCATION

Universidad Latina de Costa Rica — Master's degree, Process Management for Digital Transformation (BPM), 2021-2022

Universidad Latina de Costa Rica — Information Technology Management for Business, 2013-2017

CERTIFICATIONS

Product Management for AI and Data Science · Data Engineering on GCP · Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt · Certified SAFe Practitioner

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (native/bilingual) · German (B1, actively studying)

RECOGNITION

Employee of the Year · Data Governance Community Builder · Data Mesh MVP